UNIVERSITY OF HUDDERSFIELD CYBER SECURITY SOCIETY

HUDHACK 2026

PARTICIPANT GUIDE — BREAK THE LOOP

1 JOIN OUR DISCORD

STAY CONNECTED ALL DAY

discord.gg/MpJk8bGSRV

Scan the QR code or visit the link to join our Discord server. This is where we'll post live announcements, answer questions, share resources, and handle anything that comes up during the day. Keep an eye on **#hudhack-2026** for updates throughout the event.

2 SCHEDULE

09:30	Registration · *HA4/04*
10:00	Opening Ceremony
10:30	Team-Building Session · *By Hackathons UK*
11:00	🚀 **Hacking Begins!**
12:00	**Guest Talk** — Sam Crich (Tech Lawyer)
12:20	🍕 Lunch Break
13:00	Keep Hacking
14:00	**Workshop** — Data Protection by Design · *HA1/19*
14:45	Hacking Continues
16:15	⚡ Final Sprint — wrap up and prepare your demo
16:45	Judging & Kahoot Quiz
17:30	🏆 **Closing Ceremony & Prize Giving**
17:45	🍽️ Food & Networking
19:00	Hackathon Ends

Food will be served after the closing ceremony. We aim to finish before iftar for anyone fasting.

3 THE THEME

BREAK THE LOOP

The "Break The Loop" challenge invites you to identify everyday frustrations or problems — whether university-specific or general issues in daily life — and use technology to design practical solutions that make real improvements. How many times have you encountered a problem and hoped someone else would fix it? This is your invitation to be that person.

ACCESSIBILITY | SUSTAINABILITY | WELLBEING | SAFETY | SUPPORT

4 MAIN CHALLENGE

🎯 YOUR MISSION

IDENTIFY A REAL PROBLEM. BUILD A SOLUTION THAT BREAKS THE CYCLE.

Think about the frustrations, inefficiencies, or inequalities you or others experience every day — at university, at home, in your community. Your job is to **pick one of those problems** and build a working tech solution that genuinely addresses it. It doesn't need to be perfect — it needs to be **real, relevant, and impactful**.

The best projects will be ones that could make someone's life measurably better. There are no restrictions on which problem you choose — if it's a genuine loop worth breaking, it's fair game.

5 WHAT TO BUILD

You can build **anything that solves the problem** — there's no single right answer. Below are some formats to inspire you. Pick the one that best fits your idea and team's skills.

🌐

WEBSITE / WEB APP

A browser-based platform users can visit and interact with. Great for dashboards, information tools, or community platforms.

REACT | HTML/CSS | NEXT.JS

📱

MOBILE APP

A smartphone app that users carry with them. Ideal for on-the-go tools, alerts, or wellbeing check-ins.

FLUTTER | REACT NATIVE | SWIFT

🤖

AI / CHATBOT TOOL

An intelligent assistant or automated system that helps people get answers, support, or guidance faster.

OPENAI API | LANGCHAIN | GEMINI

🔧

CLI / SCRIPT / AUTOMATION

A command-line tool, script, or automated pipeline that removes a repetitive or manual task from someone's workflow.

PYTHON | BASH | NODE.JS

🔌

API / BACKEND SERVICE

A data service or API that other apps could plug into. Powerful for sharing data, integrating systems, or enabling analysis.

FASTAPI | EXPRESS | FLASK

💡

HARDWARE / IOT PROTOTYPE

A physical or sensor-based solution — think smart alerts, environmental monitors, or accessibility devices.

RASPBERRY PI | ARDUINO | SENSORS

💡 **Not sure what to build?** Start with the *problem*, not the technology. Describe the frustration you want to fix in one sentence, then decide which format above would best solve it. Judges care more about **impact** than stack complexity.

6 TALKS & WORKSHOPS

12:00 PM · 20 MINS

GUEST TALK

Sam Crich — Tech Lawyer

Sam will discuss the legal realities of working in tech — covering intellectual property, data liability, open-source licensing, and what every developer should know before shipping a product. Insightful and practical for anyone entering the industry.

14:00 PM · 45 MINS

WORKSHOP: DATA PROTECTION BY DESIGN

Sam Crich — Interactive Session

A hands-on workshop exploring how to bake data protection into your projects from the ground up. Sam will cover GDPR principles, practical privacy-first design patterns, and how to avoid the most common compliance mistakes developers make.

7 HOW TO SIGN UP TO CTFD

TEAMS ONLY

CTFD IS TEAM-BASED — EVERYONE MUST BE IN A TEAM TO COMPETE

One person creates the team and the rest join using the team password. All flag submissions are scored together on the leaderboard. Visit the platform at: `hudhack.ctfd.io`

CREATE A TEAM (1 PERSON DOES THIS)

1 REGISTER YOUR ACCOUNT

Go to `hudhack.ctfd.io` and click `Register`. Enter a username, email, and password.

2 CLICK "CREATE TEAM"

After registering, select `Create a Team` when prompted.

3 CHOOSE A NAME & PASSWORD

Pick a team name and password — **remember both**, you'll need to share them with your teammates so they can join.

4 SHARE WITH YOUR TEAM

Send your team name and password to everyone so they can join using the steps on the right.

JOIN A TEAM (EVERYONE ELSE)

1 REGISTER YOUR ACCOUNT

Go to `hudhack.ctfd.io` and click `Register`. Enter a username, email, and password.

2 CLICK "JOIN TEAM"

After registering, select `Join a Team` when prompted.

3 ENTER TEAM NAME & PASSWORD

Type in the team name and password your teammate shared with you, then confirm.

4 START SOLVING!

You're in. Flags look like `hudhack{example_text}` — paste them exactly to score points.

Flag submissions are case-sensitive — copy them exactly as found. All flags follow the format `hudhack{...}`

8 JUDGING CRITERIA

CATEGORY	WHAT JUDGES ARE LOOKING FOR	Score
THEME	How relevant and aligned is the solution to the "Break The Loop" theme?	/ 5
INNOVATION	Originality of the idea and creative approach to the problem.	/ 5
TECHNICAL	Quality, complexity, and engineering of the implementation.	/ 5
FUNCTION	Does it actually work? Completeness and reliability of the demo.	/ 5
IMPACT	Real-world potential — could this genuinely solve the problem at scale?	/ 5
PRESENTATION	Clarity and confidence of the demo and explanation to the judges.	/ 5

Maximum possible score:	**30 points**

9 HOW TO SUBMIT ON DEVPOST

DEADLINE

SUBMIT BY 16:45 — BEFORE JUDGING BEGINS

All projects must be submitted on Devpost before the final sprint ends. Late submissions may not be considered.

hudhack2026.devpost.com

1 GO TO THE HUDHACK 2026 DEVPOST PAGE

Visit hudhack2026.devpost.com or scan the link in **#hudhack-2026** on Discord. Click Submit Project.

2 CREATE OR LOG IN TO YOUR DEVPOST ACCOUNT

Sign up at devpost.com if you don't already have an account. Only one team member needs to submit on behalf of the whole team.

3 FILL IN YOUR PROJECT DETAILS

Add your **project name**, a short **description** of what it does and the problem it solves, and the **technologies used**. Keep it clear and concise — judges will read this.

4 ADD YOUR PROJECT LINKS

Include links to your **GitHub repo**, a **live demo** (if applicable), and any other relevant URLs. Make sure your repo is public before submitting.

5 ADD YOUR TEAM MEMBERS

Search for your teammates by their Devpost username or email and add them to the submission so everyone gets credit.

6 CLICK "SUBMIT" — YOU'RE DONE!

Double-check everything looks correct, then hit Submit Project. You can edit your submission up until the deadline, so don't stress about it being perfect first time.

> **Tips for a strong submission:** Write your description as if explaining to someone who hasn't seen your demo. Mention the problem, your solution, and any challenges you overcame. Screenshots or a short demo video go a long way!